TrimRide Cost and Subscription Model (Planning Draft)

Last Updated: 2026-05-25
Currency: USD (estimates)

One-Time Costs

- Google Play Developer account: $25 one-time.
- Apple Developer Program: $99/year (if iOS distribution is needed).
- Domain name: $10-$20/year.

Monthly Core Stack (Lean Pilot)

- Backend hosting (single small instance): $20-$60/month.
- Managed PostgreSQL: $25-$100/month.
- Error monitoring (Sentry or similar): $0-$29/month to start.
- Uptime/health monitoring: $0-$20/month.
- Email notifications/provider (basic): $0-$15/month.
- Object/file storage (if needed): $0-$20/month.

Estimated lean monthly total: $45-$244/month.

Monthly Growth Stack (Post-Pilot)

- Backend hosting (scaled): $100-$400/month.
- Managed PostgreSQL (higher tier): $100-$500/month.
- Monitoring/logging/APM: $50-$300/month.
- Analytics and product tools: $0-$200/month.
- Messaging/notification add-ons: $20-$200/month.

Estimated growth monthly total: $270-$1,600/month.

Variable Transaction Costs

- Stripe processing (typical US card baseline): ~2.9% + $0.30 per successful transaction.
- SMS/OTP (if enabled via Twilio-like provider): usage-based.
- Maps usage (Google Maps API): pay-as-you-go after free tier/credit consumption.

Recommended Purchases First (Order)

1. Reliable backend + managed PostgreSQL.
2. Error monitoring and uptime checks.
3. Domain and basic ops tooling.
4. Payment provider hardening spend.
5. Analytics and growth tooling after pilot retention data.

Suggested Funding Targets

Survival Pilot (3-4 months)

- Budget target: $5,000-$15,000.
- Focus: hardening, pilot ops, demo reliability.

Launch Pilot (6-9 months)

- Budget target: $25,000-$75,000.
- Focus: payment hardening, city pilot, reliability stack, customer acquisition tests.

Seed Expansion (12 months)

- Budget target: $100,000-$350,000.
- Focus: team buildout, multi-zone growth, deeper platform and operations.

Notes For Investor Conversations

- Present cost ranges as phased and milestone-based.
- Emphasize that FCM push itself is low-cost/free, while reliability and growth tooling scale with usage.
- Tie each spend bucket to measurable outcomes (activation, completion, repeat rate, retention).